City Metro
Customer Code of Conduct

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Title 6, Chapter 6-05 — Customer Code of Conduct

City Metro exists to move people safely, reliably, and comfortably around the region it serves. Safety is the single principle that guides everything the agency does, from how vehicles are operated to how stations are designed. But safety, comfort, and reliability aren't just things City Metro provides — they're something everyone who uses the system helps create together. This Customer Code of Conduct (the “Code”) sets out the shared expectations that make that possible.

This Code applies anywhere City Metro operates: on buses and trains, at stations and stops, in parking facilities, and anywhere else City Metro property extends. It applies equally to riders, visitors, and anyone else who sets foot on the system, and it is enforced by City Metro representatives, including fare inspectors, transit security officers, and operators acting within their authority.

6-05-010 Our Commitment and Rider Guidelines

Every rider who steps onto a City Metro vehicle or into a City Metro station can expect a few basic things in return for their fare: courteous and professional service from staff, a clean and secure environment to wait and travel in, and the ability to get where they're going without interference, harassment, or fear for their safety. None of that happens automatically — it depends on everyone on the system, riders included, holding up their end of the bargain.

In exchange, City Metro asks riders to treat fellow passengers, operators, station agents, and security staff with the same courtesy and respect they'd want for themselves, and to treat City Metro's vehicles and facilities as the shared, public resource that they are. The guidelines below summarize what that looks like in practice. They are not exhaustive — the more detailed rules further in this Code fill in the specifics — but they capture the spirit of what's expected of every rider, every trip:

- Pay the correct fare before boarding, and keep proof of payment on you for the length of your trip.
- Treat other riders, and City Metro staff, with basic courtesy and respect.
- Give up priority seating to seniors and riders with disabilities as soon as they board, without being asked.
- Personal items are welcome on board as long as they're not dangerous, don't spill into the aisle, and stay under your control in case the vehicle has to stop suddenly.
- Never threaten, harm, or harass an operator, a security officer, or a fellow rider.
- Sexual harassment of riders or employees, in any form, will not be tolerated.
- Don't create conditions that put yourself or others at risk.
- No eating or drinking on board (closed water bottles are fine).
- Respect City Metro property — graffiti, tagging, and other vandalism are prohibited.
- Use City Metro's vehicles and facilities for transportation, not as a place to live, store belongings, or conduct unrelated business.
- No smoking, vaping, or use of illegal drugs anywhere on the system.

- No riding bikes, skateboards, scooters, or rollerblades inside vehicles or stations.
- No littering, spitting, or otherwise leaving behind an unsanitary mess for the next rider.
- Keep noise to a reasonable level — no shouting matches, blasting music, or nonstop profanity where others have to listen to it.
- No fighting, and no abusive or threatening language directed at anyone.
- No soliciting, panhandling, or unauthorized commercial activity on board or in stations.
- No lewd, indecent, or otherwise inappropriate conduct.
- Weapons, explosives, and other dangerous or flammable materials are prohibited system-wide.
- Shirts, bottoms, and shoes must be worn at all times while riding or waiting.
- Vehicles parked at City Metro park-and-ride lots must follow posted signage, time limits, and permit requirements.

Following this Code is a condition of using any City Metro vehicle, station, parking facility, or other City Metro property, and is adopted under the authority granted to City Metro to operate and maintain public transit service within Lego City County.

6-05-020 Definitions

The following terms, wherever they're used in this Code, carry the meanings given below:

Abuse / Harassment: Physical or verbal mistreatment of another person, including hitting, kicking, spitting, shoving, threatening gestures, intimidation, slurs, and cursing directed at someone. This also includes sexual harassment — unwanted touching, comments, or gestures of a sexual nature, or mistreatment based on someone's gender, gender expression, gender identity, or sexual orientation.

Commercial Activity: Any for-profit activity carried out on City Metro property, including selling goods, food, or services, or distributing promotional or commercial materials.

Fare: The monetary charge City Metro sets for use of its vehicles and facilities, including any applicable transfer or pass requirements.

Loitering: Lingering in a City Metro facility or vehicle without a legitimate transit purpose, in a way that interferes with other people's use of that space.

City Metro: The Lego City County Metropolitan Transportation Authority, responsible for operating, expanding, and maintaining public transit systems in Lego City County, along with any of its contracted operators and service providers.

City Metro Facility: All property associated with the transit system, including stations, platforms, plazas, waiting areas, parking lots, walkways, elevators, escalators, ticket machines, signage, and maintenance yards.

City Metro Vehicle: Any bus, train, or other vehicle owned, leased, or operated by City Metro or by a contractor operating service on City Metro's behalf.

City Metro Representative: A security officer, operator, fare inspector, station agent, or other City Metro employee or contractor authorized to enforce this Code.

Minor: A person under the age of 18.

Sound Device: Any radio, phone, speaker, musical instrument, or similar device that plays audio or emits noise. This definition does not include assistive hearing devices used by riders with hearing impairments.

Weapon: Any firearm, knife, explosive, dangerous chemical or device, or other item carried or used with the intent of causing harm.

Wheelchair: A mobility device with three or more wheels, manual or powered, designed or adapted for use by a person with a mobility impairment.

Mobility Aid Device: Any assistive device, other than a wheelchair, primarily intended to help a person with a disability move around independently.

Notice of Violation: A citation issued by a City Metro representative documenting a Code violation and any associated fine.

Notice of Exclusion: A written order barring a person from all or part of the City Metro system for a specified period, issued under Section 6-05-240.

6-05-030 Animals

- Animals may ride the system if they meet one of two conditions: they're secured in an appropriate carrier, or they're a service animal as defined by the Americans with Disabilities Act.
- Handlers are responsible for maintaining control of their animal for the entire trip. An animal that isn't under control, or that poses a threat to riders or staff, isn't permitted on the system regardless of carrier or service-animal status.
- Carriers must be secure, appropriately sized, and used for their intended purpose — not improvised out of shopping bags or loose boxes.
- Handlers must promptly clean up any animal waste left in a City Metro facility or vehicle. Leaving it behind is a Code violation on its own.

6-05-040 Wheels, Boards, and Scooters

- Bicycles, skateboards, kick scooters, rollerblades, and similar wheeled devices may not be ridden inside vehicles or stations. Wheelchairs and mobility aid devices are the exception and are always welcome.
- Riders bringing a bicycle on board must use the designated bike racks or areas, and must keep the bike clear of aisles, doorways, and operator sightlines.
- Folding bikes and scooters should be folded when boarding during busy periods, space permitting.
- Oversized wheeled items — generally anything longer than six feet — aren't permitted on vehicles, for everyone's safety and comfort.

6-05-050 Keeping Things Moving

- Riders and visitors must allow free and safe movement of other people, as well as of vehicles and transit operations generally. That means keeping aisles, stairways, elevators, doorways, and escalators clear.
- Any activity that disrupts transit service, blocks the free movement of others, or interferes with an operator's ability to safely run their vehicle is prohibited — this includes things like standing in doorways, blocking fare gates, or crowding boarding areas unnecessarily.

6-05-060 Priority Seating

- Seats marked for priority use are reserved first for seniors and riders with disabilities. Other riders using those seats should be ready to give them up as soon as they're needed, without requiring staff to intervene.

6-05-070 Carts, Strollers & Luggage

- Carts, strollers, and luggage must be kept out of aisles and doorways and held or secured by the rider at all times — not left to roll freely.
- Wheelchairs must use elevators rather than escalators. Strollers and carts should do the same whenever an elevator is available.
- If an elevator at a station is out of service, riders using a wheelchair should notify a City Metro representative or use the station's assistance line for help.

6-05-080 Respect and Cooperation

- City Metro staff and fellow riders alike are entitled to be treated with respect — harassment of any kind, verbal, physical, or sexual, is never acceptable, on board or in stations.
- Riders are expected to follow reasonable instructions and directions given by an authorized City Metro representative, including instructions related to safety, fare enforcement, or evacuation.
- Shirts, bottoms, and shoes are required at all times while using the system.
- City Metro may refuse service, deny entry, or remove from its property anyone who will not comply with this Code or with applicable law.

6-05-090 Commercial Activity

- No one may conduct commercial activity — selling goods, food, or services, or distributing promotional materials — on City Metro vehicles or property without first getting a permit or written permission from City Metro.
- Buskers and performers should check station-specific rules; some areas may allow performance with a permit even where general commercial activity isn't allowed.

6-05-100 Keeping the System Safe

- The following are prohibited everywhere on the City Metro system: spitting; carrying hazardous or flammable materials; gambling; throwing objects at or from a vehicle; littering or dumping; and using the restroom outside of a lavatory.
- Smoking, vaping, and alcohol use are not permitted on any City Metro vehicle or in any City Metro facility.
- Food and drink are allowed only in closed, spill-proof containers.
- Sound devices must be used with headphones — riders shouldn't have to listen to someone else's music or video calls.
- Riding on the outside of a vehicle, or hanging from any part of it, is strictly prohibited, as is attaching anything to a moving vehicle.
- Benches, planters, signage, shelters, and trash containers are for their intended purpose only — not for climbing, lying down, or skateboarding.
- Weapons of any kind, as defined in Section 6-05-020, are prohibited throughout the system without exception.

6-05-110 Loitering

- City Metro facilities and vehicles exist for transit purposes. Lingering without a transit-related reason — especially in a way that blocks entrances, fare gates, or seating for other riders — isn't permitted.

6-05-120 Parking & Restricted Areas

- Vehicles parked at City Metro park-and-ride lots and garages must follow posted time limits, permit requirements, and other parking rules.
- Only authorized City Metro staff, contractors, and emergency personnel are allowed in non-public areas such as maintenance yards, control rooms, and staff-only doorways.

6-05-130 Fares

- Riders must have proof of a valid fare, pass, or transfer for their entire trip, and must show it upon request to any City Metro representative, including fare inspectors conducting routine checks.
- Riders who can't produce proof of fare when asked may be issued a citation under Section 6-05-240, regardless of whether they actually paid.

6-05-140 Solicitation

- Panhandling, begging, and other forms of solicitation are not permitted on City Metro vehicles or in City Metro facilities.

6-05-240 Enforcement

This section explains, in plain terms, how City Metro's enforcement process works, from an initial citation through review, hearing, and appeal.

A. Violations and General Remedies

A person who violates this Code is subject to a notice of violation and to whatever combination of fines, ejection, exclusion, or other remedies this Code allows. Parents or guardians of a minor may also be held responsible for fees, fines, or damages connected to their minor's citation.

B. Requesting Review of a Citation

Anyone who receives a notice of violation may ask City Metro for an initial review within 21 days of the citation being issued. This request can be made by phone, mail, or in person, and there's no charge for it. If City Metro's reviewer determines the violation didn't occur, or that the circumstances justify dismissing it, the citation can be cancelled. Either way, the person who requested the review gets a written explanation of the outcome.

If someone isn't satisfied with the result of that initial review, they can request a full administrative hearing within 21 days of receiving the review decision. A deposit equal to the citation amount is normally required to request a hearing, though that can be waived for someone who can show they're unable to pay. Hearings are generally scheduled within 90 days of the request.

C. How an Administrative Hearing Works

The person contesting a citation can choose to have their hearing conducted in person or by mail, and isn't required to attend in person if they'd rather not. Hearings are run by an independent hearing officer whose job security doesn't depend on how much money they collect in fines — the process is meant to be fair and impartial, not a revenue exercise.

The City Metro representative who issued the original citation isn't required to show up; the citation itself, if properly filled out, counts as basic evidence that the violation happened. From there, the hearing officer can dismiss the citation, uphold it, reduce the fine, allow payment in installments, or offer alternatives like a training course or community service, depending on what seems fair given the circumstances. Decisions are delivered in writing, either in person or by mail.

D. Ejection

A City Metro representative who witnesses a violation can order the person responsible to leave the vehicle or facility immediately, without a fare refund. Ejection can be issued on its own or alongside a citation, and doesn't require a prior warning, although representatives may choose to give one first.

E. Exclusion

For more serious or repeated violations, City Metro can bar someone from all or part of the system for a set period of time — this is called exclusion. Grounds for exclusion generally include: receiving citations for the same type of violation three or more times within a 12-month period; failing to pay a fine or resolve a citation when it was due; or being charged with, or convicted of, a crime that took place on City Metro property.

A notice of exclusion spells out the reason for the exclusion, which stations or lines it covers, how long it lasts, what happens if it's violated, and how to appeal it. Exclusions typically take effect a few days after the notice is received, except for very short exclusions (a day or less), which can take effect immediately. Requesting a review of an exclusion pauses it until the review is decided.

F. Appealing an Exclusion

Someone who receives a notice of exclusion can request a review in writing within five days of receiving it. The request can ask that the exclusion be cancelled entirely, that its scope be narrowed, that its length be shortened, or that the person be allowed to complete an alternative program instead. As with citation appeals, this review is handled by an independent hearing officer who considers the evidence from both City Metro and the excluded person, including any written statements or documentation submitted.

G. Continuing Authority

City Metro is responsible for adopting and maintaining a schedule of fines and penalties, along with whatever procedures are needed to keep the enforcement process running fairly and consistently. Changes to that schedule require sign-off from City Metro's governing board or chief executive.

Fine Schedule

Below is the schedule of consequences for Code violations, following a tiered warning-fine-ejection-exclusion structure.

Written Warning

Issued at a representative's discretion for a first-time, non-serious violation. It documents the issue but carries no fine — mostly a way of putting someone on notice before anything more formal happens.

Notice of Violation

A standard citation carrying a fine of $75 for an adult or $40 for a minor. Fines can be paid online, by mail, or in person, or appealed through the review process described in Section 6-05-240, within 21 days of issuance. Minors are expected to show proof of age or current school enrollment; without it, a person is treated as an adult for fine purposes.

Ejection

A same-day order to leave City Metro property, valid until the person is back in compliance with the Code. Ejection doesn't carry its own fine but can be layered on top of a citation.

Notice of Exclusion

A longer-term ban from all or part of the system: 30 days for a first exclusion, 60 days for a second, and 90 days for a third or any exclusion after that. Notices can be appealed within three days of being received; otherwise they take effect automatically.

Orientation Course Discount

A rider who completes City Metro's online orientation course can knock $50 off an adult fine or $30 off a minor's fine. Only one completion certificate can be applied per 12-month period, and it has to be presented at the time the fine is paid.

Community Service & Installment Payments

With a hearing officer's approval, unpaid community service can offset a fine at a rate of $15 per completed hour (no credit for partial hours), and can be combined with a partial payment or the orientation-course discount. Proof of completed service is due within 120 days of approval. Riders who need more time to pay can also request an installment plan before a fine becomes overdue; missed installments can trigger late fees of $25 at 25 days and another $25 at 45 days.

Consequence	When it applies	Amount
Written Warning	First-time, minor violation	No fine
Notice of Violation	Standard violation	$75 (adult) / $40 (minor)
Ejection	Ordered to leave for the day	N/A
Notice of Exclusion (1st)	Repeat or serious violation	30 days
Notice of Exclusion (2nd)	Second exclusion within a period	60 days
Notice of Exclusion (3rd+)	Third or further exclusion	90 days

Orientation Course Discount	Completing City Metro's course	-$50 (adult) / -$30 (minor)
Community Service Credit	Approved service in lieu of payment	$15 credit / hour
Late Fee (25 days)	Fine unpaid past 25 days	+$25
Late Fee (45 days)	Fine still unpaid past 45 days	+$25 more

Questions about a citation, or want to learn more about City Metro's police and enforcement program? Visit **police.citymetro.xyz**.

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